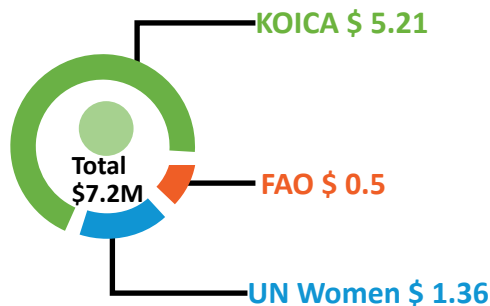


WOMEN ECONOMIC EMPOWERMENT THROUGH CLIMATE-SMART AGRICULTURE (WEE-CSA)

The WEE-CSA project, funded by the Korea International Cooperation Agency (KOICA) and implemented by UN Women in partnership with FAO, national and county governments, and civil society organizations, aimed to empower women in Kenya's arid and semi-arid regions: *Kitui, Laikipia, and West Pokot Counties* through climate-smart agriculture (CSA). With a budget of **\$7.2 million** (KOICA \$ 5.21, UN Women \$ 1.36, FAO \$ 0.5), the **4-year** project ran from July 2020 to June 2024, including the COVID-19 extension to **30th June 2024**.



The WEE-CSA sought to equip women (**80%** of **2,400** direct beneficiaries)-alongside men, youth, and people with disabilities-with the tools, knowledge, and resources to adapt to climate change and thrive in agriculture. Also, it worked to mainstream gender in CSA policies, plans and strengthen institutional capacity at both the national and county levels.

Beneficiaries



Key Achievements



Exceeded outreach goals by **12.83%**, reaching over **2,708** farmers.



Boosted women's participation in CSA investments from **13%** to **20%**.



Expanded CSA land use per household from **0.22** to **0.34** hectares.



Improved access to water harvesting for women from **59%** to **85%**.



Raised household incomes by **36%**, from **KES 92,543** to **KES 131,790**.



Aligned county plans with national CSA and climate change policies.



Reduced household conflicts and promoted gender equality.

Lessons Learned



Gender-responsive CSA policies can influence county budgets.



Women are central to climate resilience and food and nutrition security.



Inclusive approaches enhance access to land and other productive resources.



Delays in asset support can hinder resilience and impact sustainability.



Persistent awareness and training are vital to shift cultural norms.

The project's success was recognized by the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD), featured in **38** countries, and led to academic publications and new funding proposals. Despite an unsuccessful bid for a second phase in 2024, **WEE-CSA** stands as a model for gender-inclusive climate action. Below is the comparison of **phase I**

Phase I

BUDGET



Budget **USD: 7.2m**
Duration: **2020- 2024**

COUNTIES



3 Counties

GROUPS



108 Groups

HOUSEHOLDS



2,400

PEOPLE



12,000

APPROACHES



Use county government officers and civil society organisations (CSOs)

OUTCOMES



Increase gender responsiveness of climate-smart policies and regulations at the national, county, and community level.



Increase production, nutrition, and gender responsive climate climate-resilient livelihoods among targeted communities.